EXPERIMENT 4

Data Modelling and Form Design for a Business Application in Zoho Creator

Aim

To create a data model and to design a job application form named Job_Application_Form in Zoho Creator, using all 13 Basic Field types, for the Recruitment & Job Application Management application.

Procedure

Part A: Data Modelling

1. List the information the application must store. It is grouped as follows:

- **Candidate details:** name, address and contact number.
- **Contact and online presence:** email address and LinkedIn profile.
- **Job and experience:** department applied for, employment type, years of experience, key skills and available joining date.
- **Interview and consent:** preferred interview time, cover letter and consent for background verification.

2. Give each item a field name and a field type. All of these are kept in one form, Job_Application_Form:

- Candidate_Name – Name
- Current_Address – Address
- Contact_Number – Phone
- Email_Address – Email
- LinkedIn_Profile – Single Line
- Department_Applied_For – Drop Down
- Employment_Type_Preferred – Radio
- Key_Skills – Multi Select
- Years_Of_Experience – Number
- Available_Joining_Date – Date
- Preferred_Interview_Time – Time
- Cover_Letter – Multi Line
- Background_Verification – Checkbox

3. Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the existing application **Recruitment & Job Application Management**. Click the + button and choose to create a new form. The dialog asking how to create the form is shown in Figure 1.

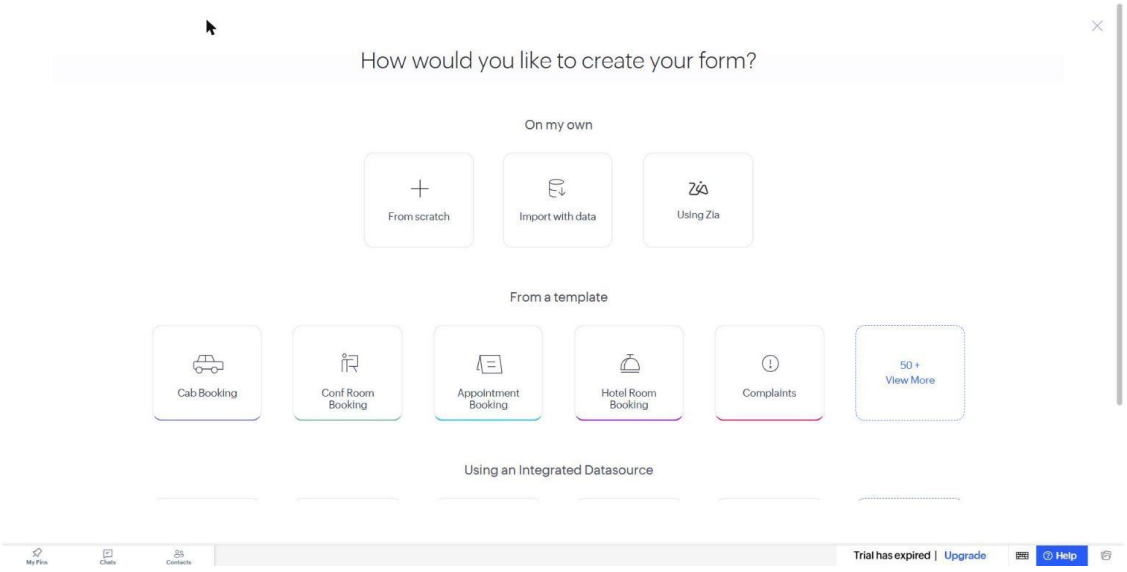


Figure 1: Options for creating the form

4. Select **Create from Scratch**. In the **Name form** box, type **Job_Application_Form**, as shown in Figure 2, and click **Create**. The form builder opens.

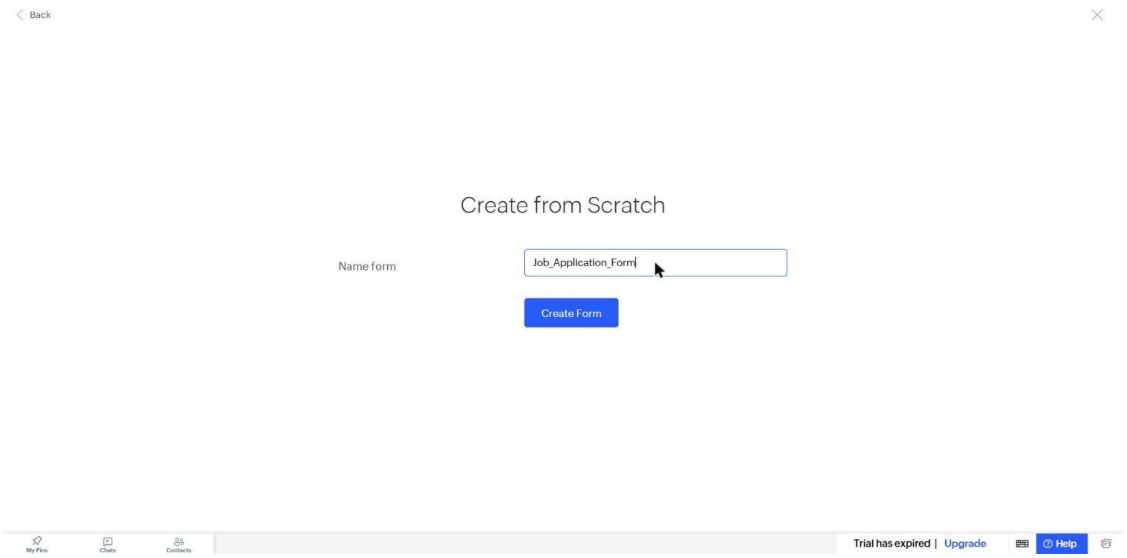


Figure 2: Form name entered as Job_Application_Form

Part B: Form Design

1. The form builder opens with the Basic Fields list on the left, an empty form area in the centre and Field Properties on the right (Figure 3).

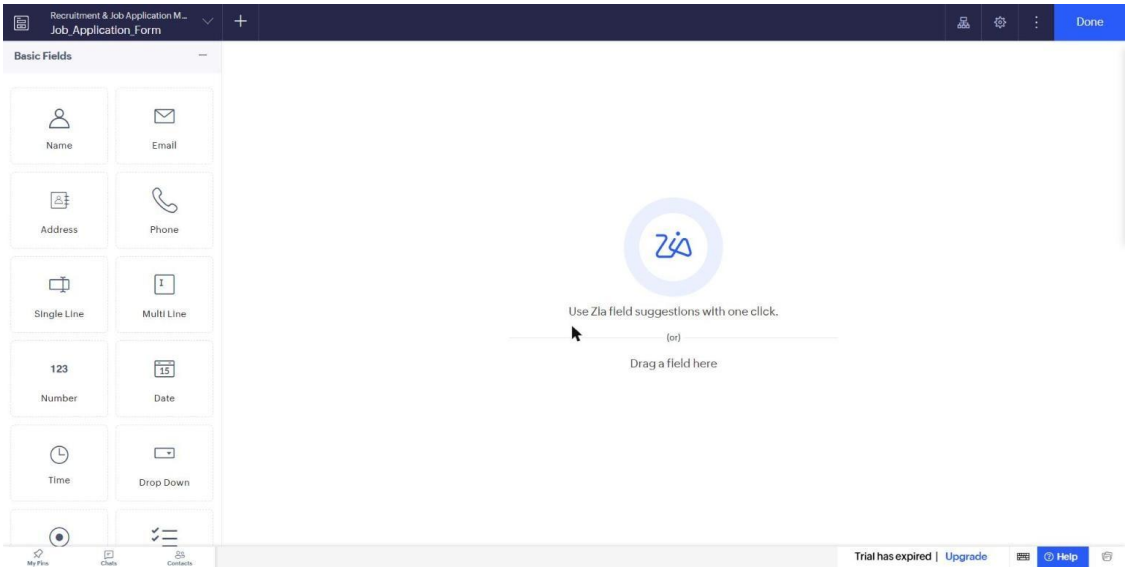


Figure 3: Blank form builder with the Basic Fields list

2. Drag the **Name** field from the left list and drop it on the form area. The Field Properties panel opens (Figure 4).

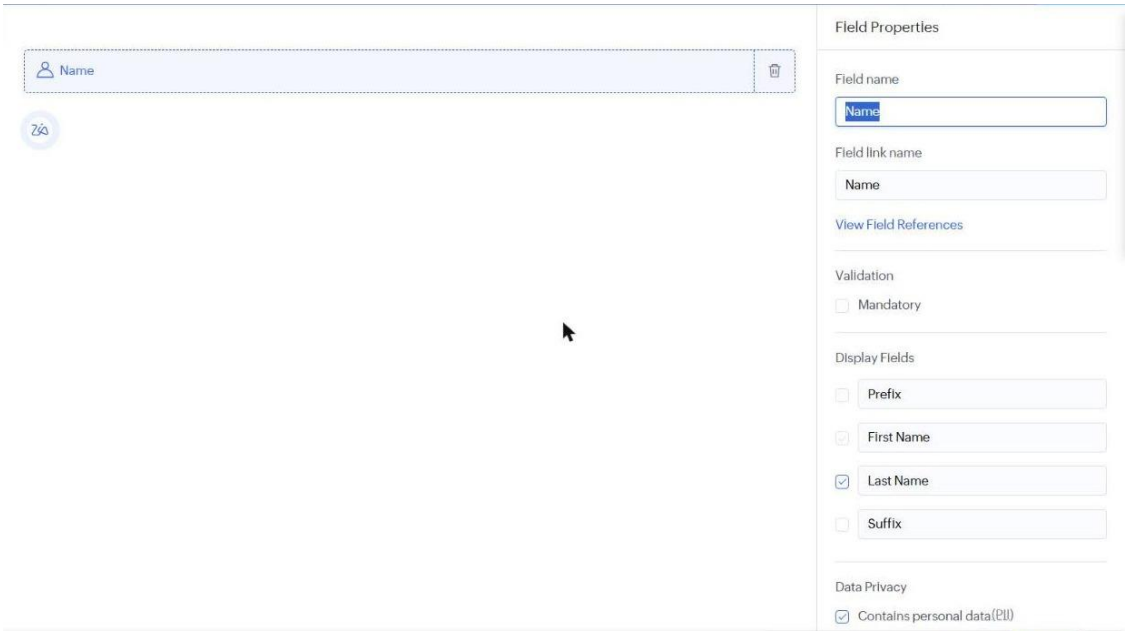


Figure 4: Name field dropped on the form

3. In **Field name**, replace the text with **Candidate_Name**. Under Validation, tick **Mandatory**. A red star appears next to the field (Figure 5).

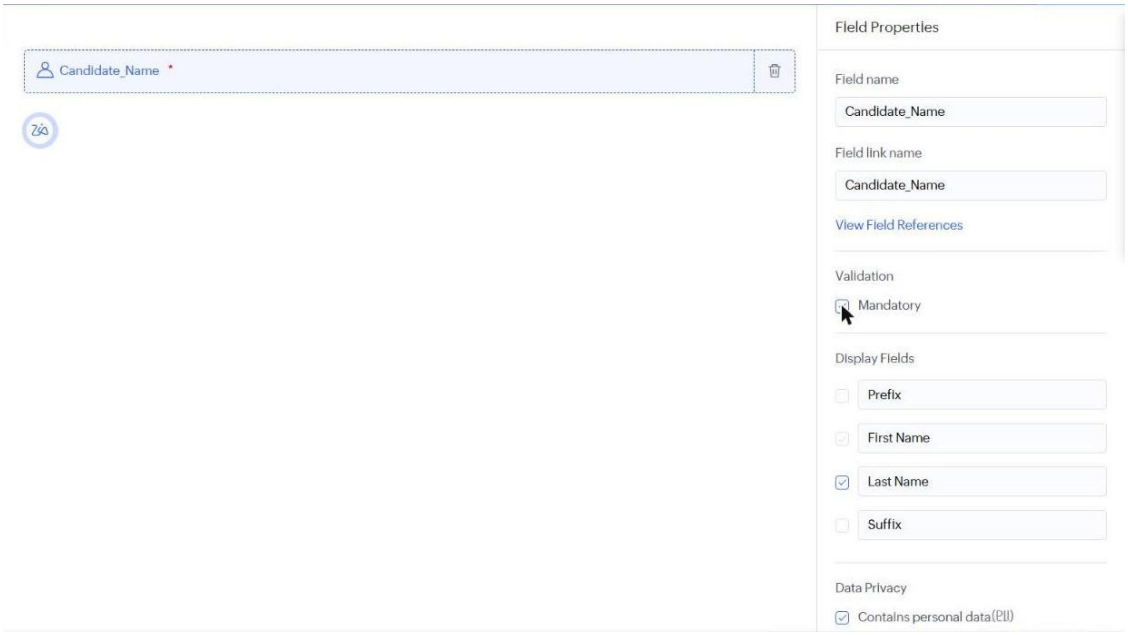


Figure 5: Field renamed to Candidate_Name and made mandatory

4. Add the other fields in the same way. Drag the field from the left list to the form area, type its name in **Field name**, and then set its options. The fields are added in this order:
    - **Address** → Current_Address.
    - **Phone** → Contact_Number. Tick **Mandatory**. Scroll down in Field Properties, click **Default country code**, search for **India**, select it and click **Configure** (Figure 6).
    - **Email** → Email_Address. Tick **Mandatory**.
    - **Single Line** → LinkedIn_Profile.

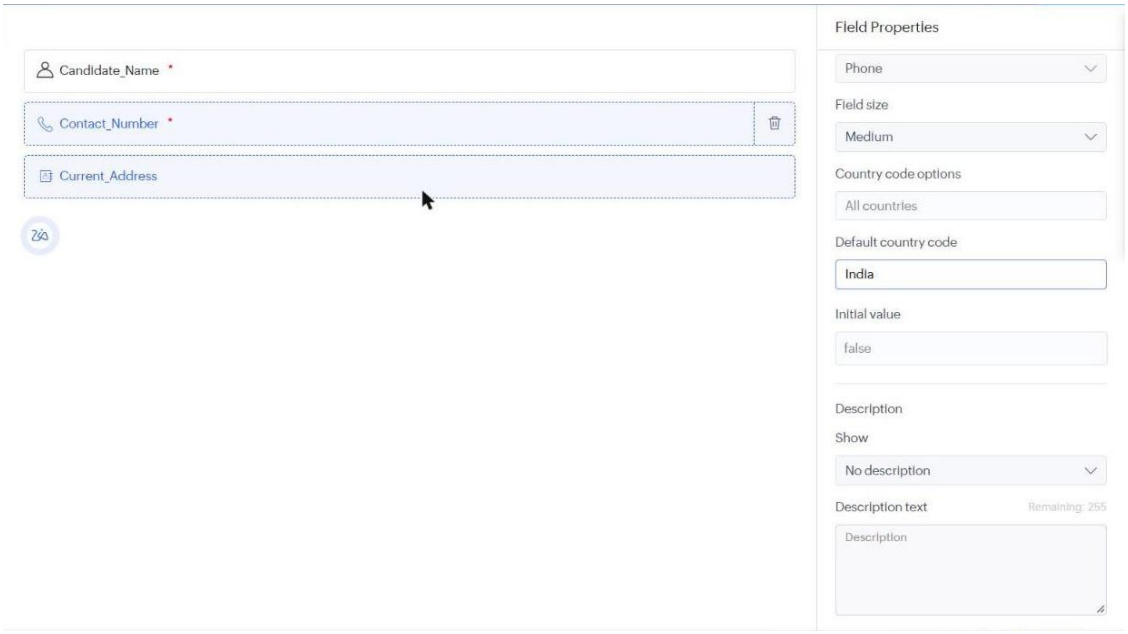


Figure 6: Contact_Number with India as the default country code

5. Drag **Drop Down** onto the form and name it **Department_Applied_For**. Replace the three default choices with Software Development, Human Resources and Marketing, and tick **Mandatory** (Figure 7).

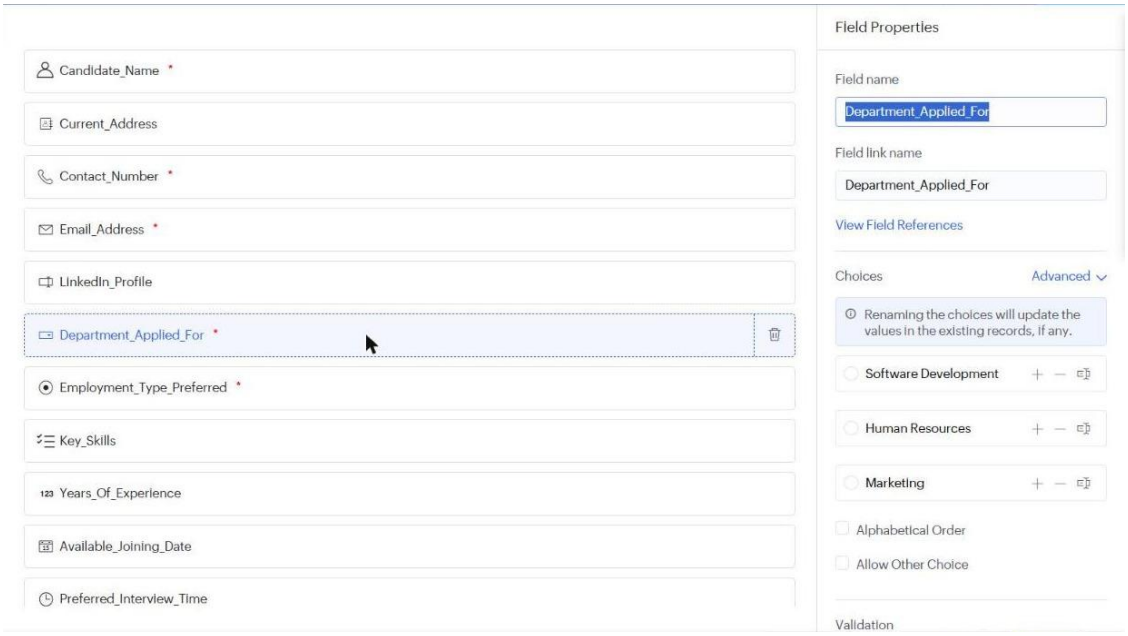


Figure 7: Department_Applied_For drop-down choices

6. Drag **Radio** onto the form and name it **Employment_Type_Preferred**. Enter the choices Full-Time, Part-Time and Internship, and tick **Mandatory** (Figure 8).

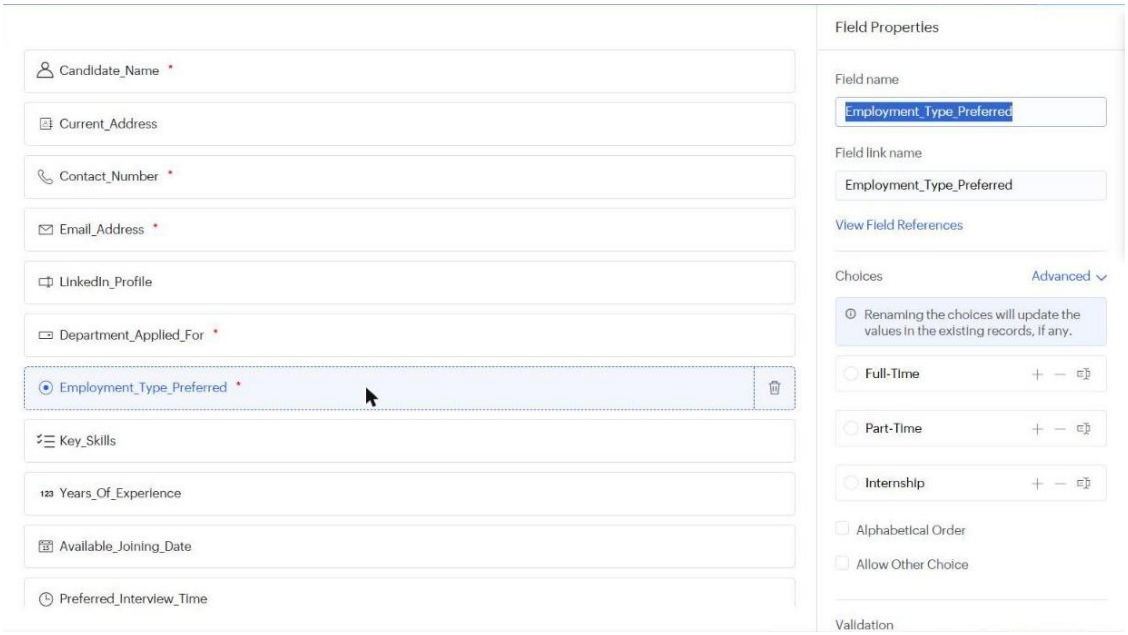


Figure 8: Employment_Type_Preferred radio choices

7. Drag **Multi Select** onto the form and name it **Key_Skills**. Enter the choices Java, React, SQL and Communication. A fourth choice is added by clicking the + beside the third choice (Figure 9).

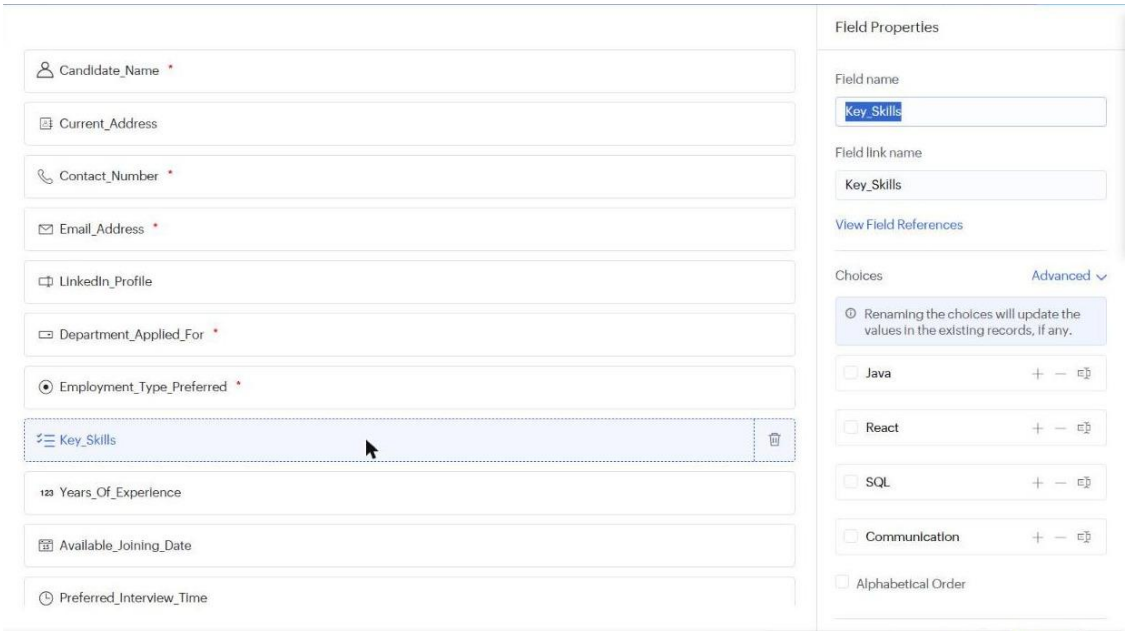


Figure 9: Key_Skills multi select choices

8. Drag **Number** onto the form and name it **Years_Of_Experience**. This field only offers a **Max Digits** setting, which was changed to 2 (Figure 10). The field has no minimum or maximum value setting.

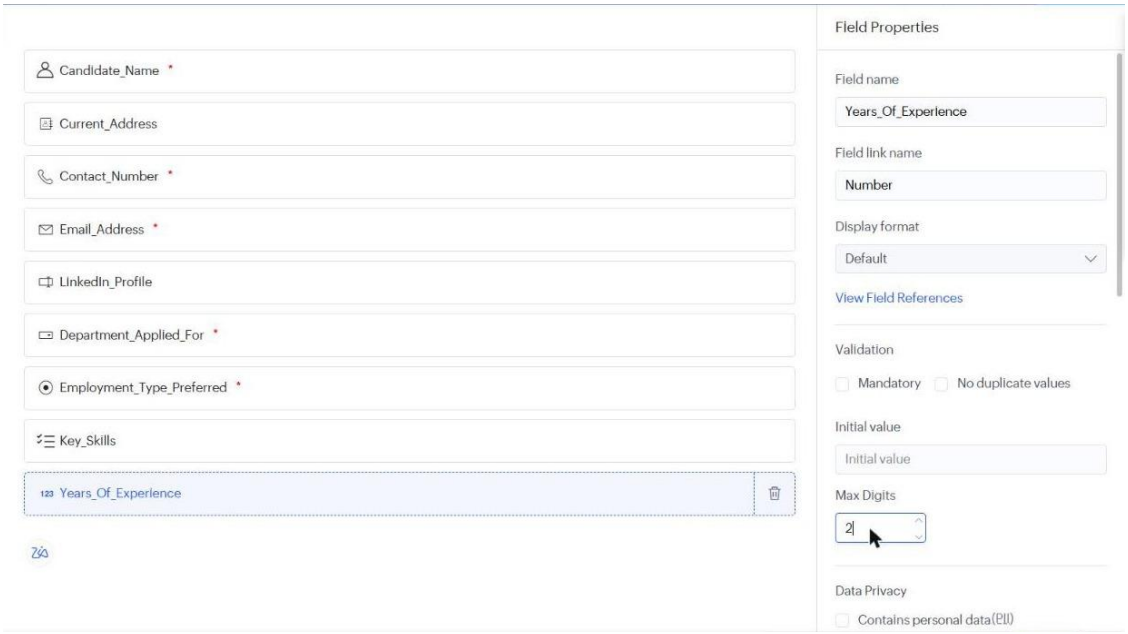


Figure 10: Years_Of_Experience with Max Digits set to 2

9. Drag **Date** onto the form and name it **Available_Joining_Date**. Its properties offer only Initial value and Allowed Days (Figure 11); there is no option to block past dates.

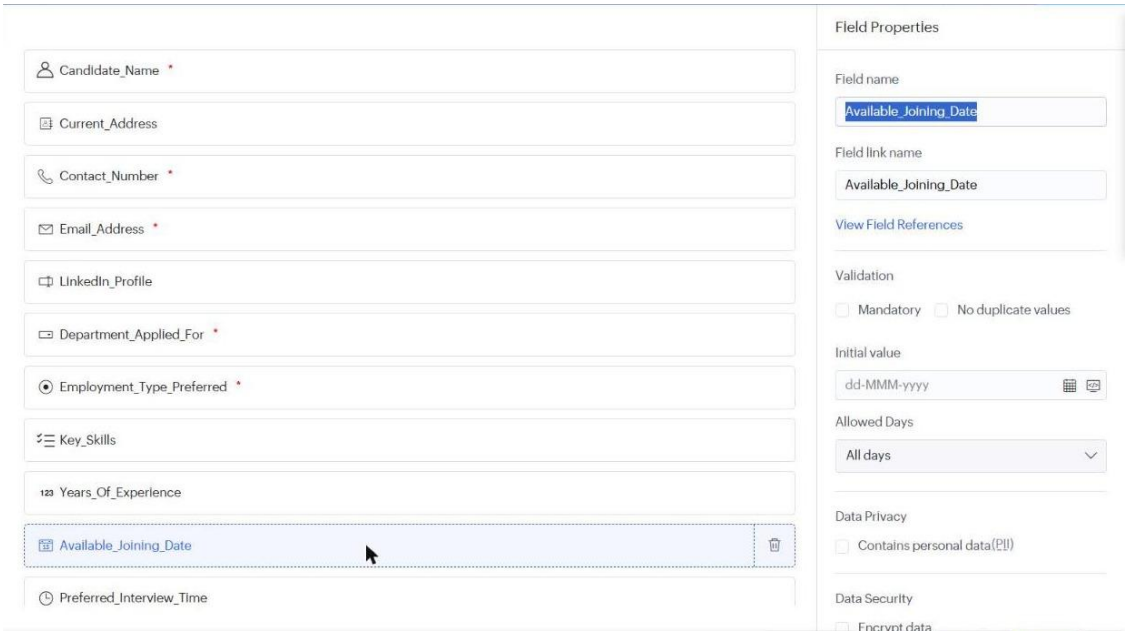


Figure 11: Available_Joining_Date properties

10. Drag **Time** onto the form and name it **Preferred_Interview_Time**. Drag **Multi Line** onto the form and name it **Cover_Letter**.

11. Drag **Checkbox** onto the form and name it **Background_Verification**. Delete the extra choices with the − button, change the remaining choice to **I consent to background verification**, and tick **Mandatory** (Figure 12).

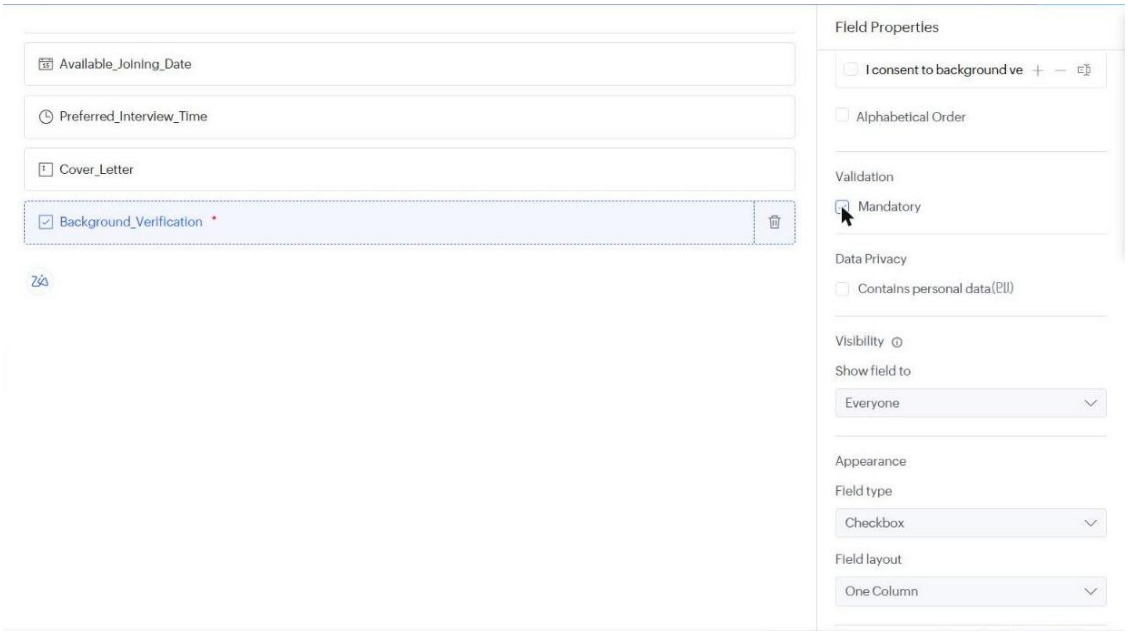


Figure 12: Background_Verification checkbox with Mandatory ticked

12. Scroll to the top of the form area to check all fields. The builder shows **Saved** at the top (Figure 13).

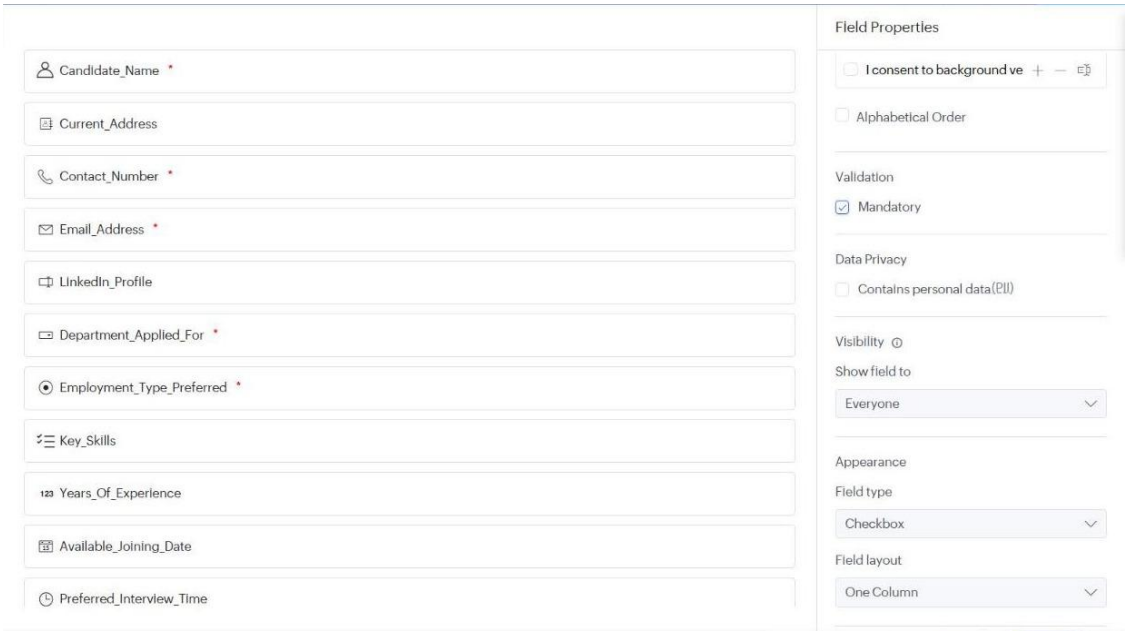


Figure 13: Form builder showing the fields (top part of the form)

13. Click **Done**. The form design view opens and shows the form with its fields, including the +91 country code on Contact_Number (Figure 14). No record was submitted.

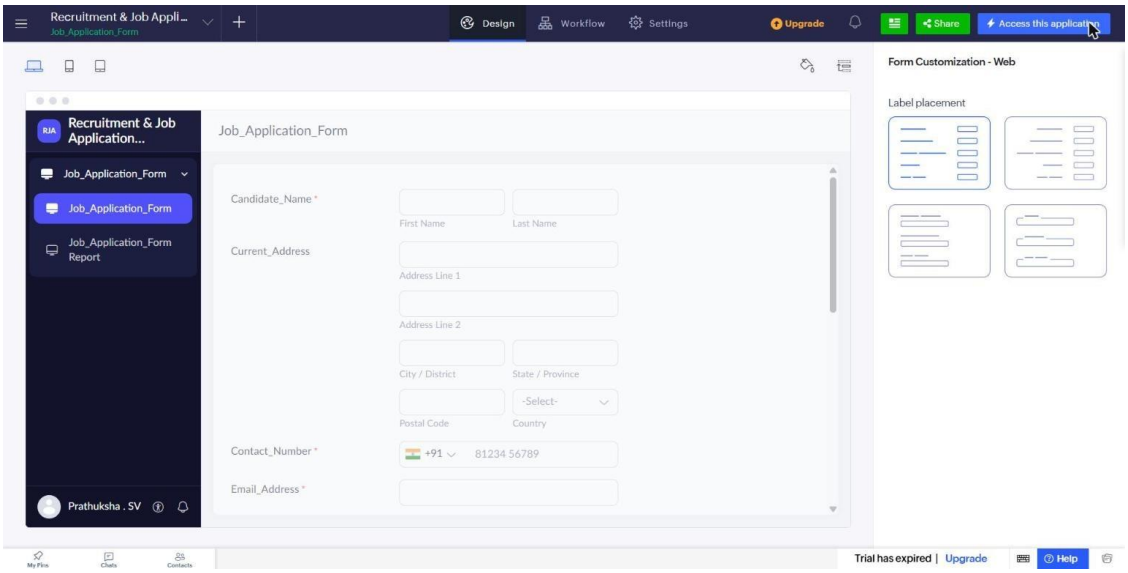


Figure 14: Job_Application_Form in the design view

14. Zoho Creator created a report for the form automatically. Open it with **Open Builder**, click the ⋮ menu at the top right, and choose **Rename**. Enter **Candidate_Application_Report** in both Report title and Report link name (Figure 15), and click **Rename**.

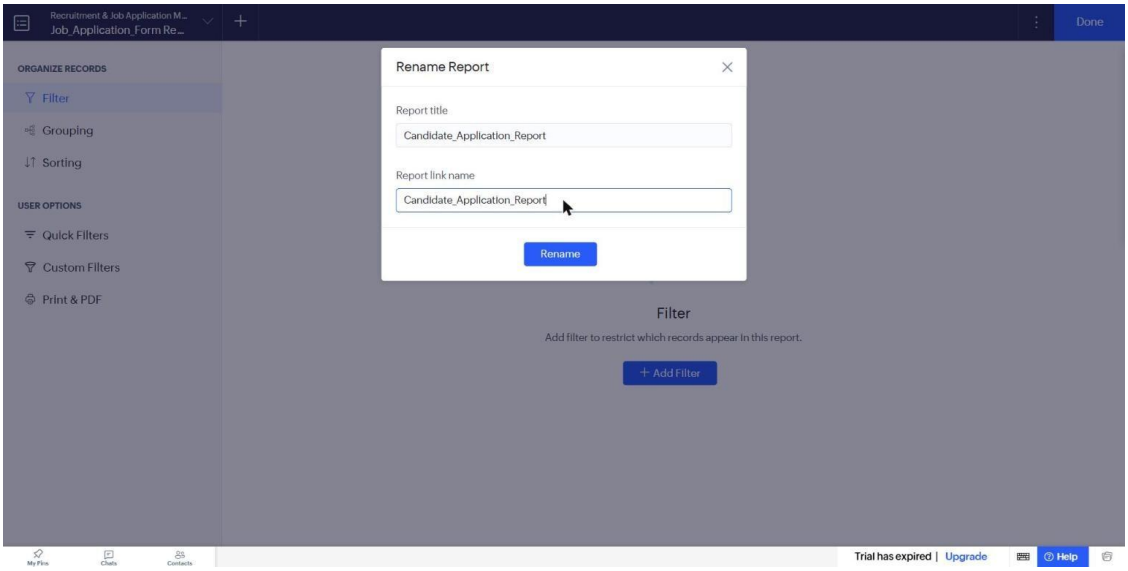


Figure 15: Rename Report dialog

15. Click **Done**. The report now appears as Candidate_Application_Report in the application, with a column for each field (Figure 16).

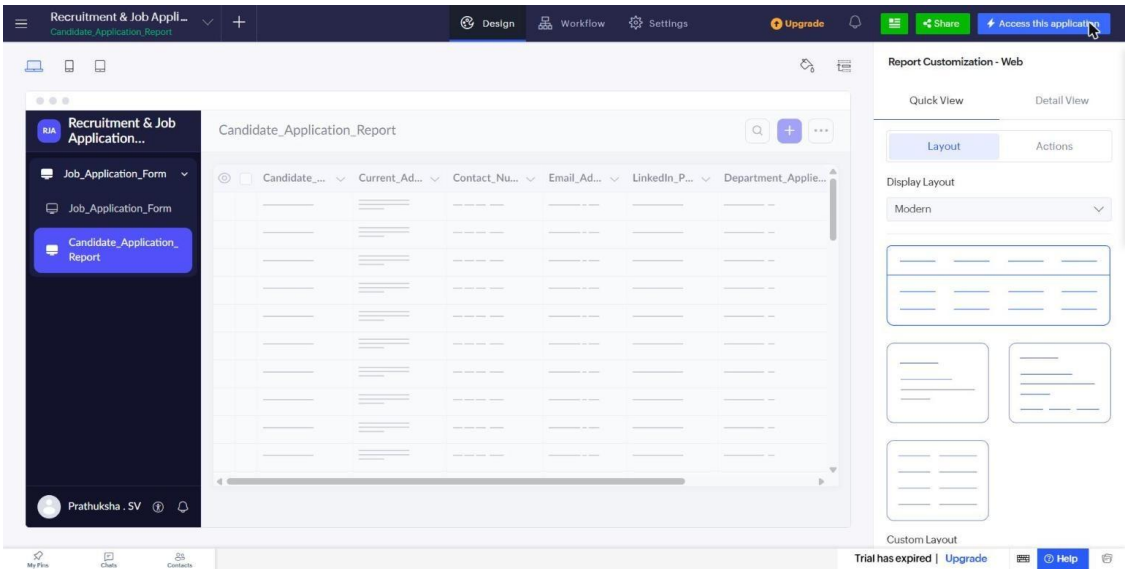


Figure 16: Report renamed as Candidate_Application_Report

Result

The form Job_Application_Form was created in the Recruitment & Job Application Management application with all 13 Basic Field types: Name, Address, Phone, Email, Single Line, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, Number, Date, Time, Multi Line and Checkbox. Candidate_Name, Contact_Number, Email_Address, Department_Applied_For, Employment_Type_Preferred and Background_Verification were set as mandatory, and the default country code of Contact_Number was set to India (+91). The report was renamed Candidate_Application_Report.

The 0 to 40 range for Years_Of_Experience and the block on past joining dates could not be set because these options are not available in the field properties. Only Max Digits was set to 2 for the number field. Sections were not created, and the form was not submitted or tested with data.